

Final Draft

“Congratulations, fellow Starr! You have been promoted to Bronze floor.”

Caitlyn’s phone lit up bright with the single line of message, unadorned but impactful. As Caitlyn checked the notification on her phone, a burst of joy exploded inside her. Although she had been working pretty hard recently, such an achievement felt unexpected.

Still in awe of the message, she suppressed the outbursting exuberance and took a screenshot of her device. In less than a few seconds, she had her SnapStarr app open, flying her fingers around like an orchestrated piece. As she selected the screenshot she just took, she captioned Starrtags like “★FinallyBronze” and “★ThxYall.” Then, she posted it.

“Did I just reach a thousand followers?” Caitlyn asked herself in disbelief. She quickly packed all her belongings into a luggage bag and got outside. Although she packed all her possessions, the bag was light enough to be held in one hand. With burdensome light footsteps, she stepped on the platform outside her door. A few seconds later, the screeching brakes of the carriage drew closer. Finally, the star-like, bright orange-colored tram came to an abrupt halt. With her heart pounding even faster than her footsteps, she managed to heave herself on board, even though riding the tram meant risking her life.

She felt uneasy as the indifferent environment of the tram cascaded over her natural setting. The pungent smell of mystery, which she could not distinguish as it was her first time smelling such a smell, invaded her nose. There was nothing but the people inside the tram, all dressed in modest clothes. There was not even a single seat for people to sit on. Almost everybody was on their devices, and Caitlyn even spotted a few doing Starrstreams. The bedazzling scene drew her eyes as far as they could reach, evaluating every single person, every single crevice of the tram.

As she scanned the tram, she locked eyes with another person who probably was the only one not looking at their phone, except Caitlyn. She approached her at a slow pace with a luggage bag that looked as light as Caitlyn’s.

“Hi! I’m Violet.”

That was when Caitlyn remembered where she had seen Violet.

“Oh! Hi! I’m Caitlyn. I follow you!”

“Yeah! Me too!”

Caitlyn, grasping onto the most familiar thing in the entire tram, continued to converse.

“I love your content.”

“OMG! I love *your* content!”

The two girls giggled for a moment, complimenting each other’s looks.

Caitlyn’s giggle conveyed a multitude of hidden masks behind her true emotions. She knew that the *other girl* was more attractive and had a demeanor that exuded an aura of sexiness for her audience. They were complete opposites. To be frank, Caitlyn took more than a year to reach this point of transition, but for Violet, it took no longer than a week. That was the harsh reality, and it struck harder than a ton of bricks for Caitlyn.

“Anyways, I hope to see you again.” Violet said with a bitter smile, concluding the conversation.

“Welcome to the Bronze.”

The artificial voice greeted Caitlyn, Violet, and others with a sense of congratulations. The passengers of the tram moved on instantly, getting out of the tram by pushing themselves. As

Caitlyn followed the crowd, she was able to see the Bronze Floor. The studio apartments, the streets, everything that made up the city were simply comparable to the austere streets of the Nobody.

She unpacked her belongings and visited her studio, filled with basic equipment that was given to her on the Bronze floor. For the first week, Caitlyn adjusted to life on the Bronze floor. She kept on with the videos she made, which were basically vlogs about her regular daily life consisting of regular activities such as shopping and cooking. However, not even two weeks into the Bronze floor, Caitlyn received a warning that she was in danger of being demoted. To her surprise, she only had two more than a thousand followers, putting her in a precarious situation. Caitlyn did not have any time to waste. She needed to do something rather than do nothing. If she were to get demoted, she would be dead. Although the ascent of floors gave tremendous benefits like fame, wealth, and lifestyle, a single demotion would kill the Starr.

That was when a message appeared on the screen of the studio:

“Sponsorship offer from Moon Hospital!”

As Caitlyn touched the screen once, the terms and conditions for the sponsorship popped up. The sponsorship offered Caitlyn plastic surgeries including facelifts, tummy tucks, liposuction, and breast augmentation. In return, Caitlyn needed to give 15% of her profit, equivalent to her earnings back in Nobody.

Desperate to gain followers and avoid ultimate consequence, Caitlyn pressed “Agree” without a second thought. As soon as she did that, a mysterious gas started to form around her and fill up her small studio. A single cough. That was all she could remember.

Caitlyn’s eyes slowly opened. She knew something had changed. With half-open eyelids, she carried her body to the bathroom. Caitlyn was greeted by a beautiful, attractive lady in the mirror. At first, she was frightened by the unexpected view, but the fear turned into excitement as she examined the woman in the mirror. An astoundingly gorgeous face, a slim body, and, to top it off, voluminous breasts that screamed sex appeal asserted their presence and triggered her confidence.

“I just look like that famous Starr!” Caitlyn exclaimed, with her eyes still glued to the woman in the mirror.

Caitlyn went straight to work. Her transformation increased her productivity and her approach to viewers. Either because of getting the demotion notice message or because of her overconfidence from the transformation, she had a new goal— to reach The Star.

With her new face and body, the views of her videos grew exponentially, her followers doubling day after day. Even if the content she made was shorter and less thoughtful than it used to be, the views, the hearts, and the followers did not seem so. Every day was a joy for Caitlyn, her pride and esteem growing near the point of becoming condescending.

“Congratulations! You have been promoted to Silver floor.”

Her phone rang again within a few days after the transformation. Caitlyn was able to feel the joy bursting within her as if it were a drop of paint dropped into a glass of water. And yet again, she tagged her success. The thought of how easy it was to reach a hundred thousand followers pressed her to crave even more.

Caitlyn headed to the station where she had arrived just two weeks before. As the tram that

would send her to the Silver floor arrived, Caitlyn streamed herself with the camera, all fancy and gorgeous with extravagant outfits and sunglasses.

"Welcome to the Silver."

The tram reached the next floor in a moment, and Caitlyn breathed the air of the Silver floor, which she felt was deserved for herself.

There was no stalling in the growth of Caitlyn's popularity, even on the Silver floor. With the makeup artist she received on the Silver floor, once again Caitlyn was able to gain a ton of followers without any effort. She randomly took videos of her doing nothing, didn't even edit them rigorously, but she still got hundreds of thousands to millions of views per video.

There were always sponsorship offers made to her, ranging from diet products to mid-range accessory brands. And when Caitlyn had nearly been on the Silver floor for a week, she was notified that she had been promoted to the Gold floor as she reached 1 million followers.

No gratitude, no commendation to her fandom. She knew she deserved it.

"Welcome to the Gold."

The Gold Floor didn't discontinue the rapid growth of her viewership. It seemed there was nothing to delay her prosperity and increase her fan base. Caitlyn indulged in her life, always decorating herself with luxurious dresses, bags, and accessories. As she now had a personal editor thanks to reaching the Gold floor, she made no effort in uploading videos. However, that is when it took a turn. After a week or two on the Gold floor, Caitlyn's increase in followers started to slow down, eventually reaching its plateau. The number of sponsorships that Caitlyn got also decreased, and the views of the videos stagnated.

Caitlyn soon became aware of the situation. She was forced to think of a new way to grasp the attention of the viewers and make them click on her videos again. But even after spending hours thinking of potential content, Caitlyn wasn't able to find a single satisfactory idea. But then, one video popped up for her.

"Jinx just got canceled for faking his content."

An anonymous speaker with a mask on his face said this with a weird autotuned voice.

"That's probably fake," Caitlyn whispered to herself, clicking on the comments section.

Thousands of comments were debating the authenticity of the news, even though the Starr's followers were barely over a thousand.

That was when she got the idea.

A moment of realization struck her. If she did anything like that, people would believe her, just as they do for others who believe everything on social media. People would become interested because they care about celebrities, and they would love her because she is beautiful. Of course, Caitlyn knew that the people she accused would face consequences and have their lives threatened. But it did not outweigh her survival and fame.

Caitlyn searched for random Starrs that would become the victims of her videos. She randomly chose a Starr that had fewer followers than her and had inappropriate content.

"A famous Starr, Zeri, was accused of wearing an inappropriate outfit as she wore a transparent dress during one of her videos."

Caitlyn immediately started filming herself, creating a story from the top of her head. After an hour, her editor uploaded the video, which got immediate attention as soon as it was posted. Within an hour of posting, the video became the #1 trending video on SnapStarr, causing

Caitlyn to gain a million followers within a day.

Caitlyn was amazed by this sudden outpouring of followers, and she instantly felt that this would make her 'the Star.'

Day after day, Caitlyn posted new videos about scandals involving other Starrs, ranging from social media drama to offensive comments. With each video, Caitlyn got at least a few million views and more than a million followers. Within two weeks, Caitlyn got promoted to the Diamond floor, skipping the Platinum floor due to the potential exponential growth of her account.

"Welcome to the Diamond."

As soon as Caitlyn got off of the tram, a beautiful landscape of a concrete jungle with some touches of green greeted her. The buildings were sky-high, offering stunning views at every corner. However, this did not even register for her.

Caitlyn was obsessed with her content.

She made her videos with more provocative scandals, even if the stories were not even based on facts. She created rumors about famous Starrs, ranging from the Platinum floor to the Diamond floor, calling out ridiculous things. Driven by greed, she didn't care about other Starrs' reputations or their possible demotions.

"The famous Starr's past activities of sleeping with multiple men to get sponsorship have been revealed recently."

"The famous Starr was accused of bullying in his school years."

"The famous Starr is known to have changed gender through a surgical procedure."

"It's for their own good," Caitlyn thought to herself, unconsciously justifying her actions.

Soon, there were criticisms of Caitlyn in her comments and in other videos about her, accusing her of fabricating content. But it was too minor to even leave a scratch on Caitlyn's image.

Cupcakes, her followers, believed in her regardless of everything, defending her stance and praising her as if she were a goddess.

Ironically, despite Caitlyn's increasingly provocative content with the support of her fandom, her follower growth began to slow down. She was not satisfied with this, even though she was in a position where most of the Starrs admired her and wanted her followers. Caitlyn was still hungry to reach the top, to become "The Star."

So, Caitlyn now tried to make up and use information that wasn't confirmed true or even discussed by others. As she searched for famous Starrs to become the victims of her next video, she found Violet. Violet, even prettier than when Caitlyn last saw her on the train to the Bronze floor, had even more followers than Caitlyn herself and was near reaching The Star. The aura of sexiness and prettiness, just like when Caitlyn last saw her, flowed out of Violet even through the screen.

Caitlyn felt a rush of emotion. A feeling she should not have had. She felt envious of Violet. All the effort she had put in to reach the top—receiving plastic surgeries, figuring out content, and creating rumors about others—felt as if it were nothing. The pretty girl on the screen had everything without even making the slightest effort. Her content was nothing but a mere boring subject, yet her physical appearance and the beauty of her countenance were irresistible.

"This is unfair. How come she did nothing and is still better than me?"

Caitlyn asked herself. That was when she decided to betray her old friend.

“The famous Starr, Violet, has been recently found to have been sexually abusing minors. She was known to molest several kids in the past and even in recent days.”

Caitlyn sent the recorded video and a deepfaked video of “proof” to her editor and felt a rush of adrenaline, believing she had done what was deserved for both her and Violet. With her heart pounding with every moment of excitement, she barely managed to sleep.

As expected, her followers multiplied. With just a few more, Caitlyn was finally able to reach the top level, becoming ‘The Star.’ Happy days went by without any videos being made.

“Welcome to the Star.”

The place was a real-life paradise. The buildings looked like castles, with gardens and fountains surrounding the mansions. Every restaurant was owned by chefs whose food was beyond any taste. Every piece of jewelry shone beautifully, reflecting lights in the spectrum of the rainbow. In this real-life heaven, Caitlyn indulged in luxury, covering herself with fanciful branded clothing and accessories.

Thinking that she was now the star—the number one on the entire SnapStarr platform—Caitlyn felt happiness every day. She was always filled with self-confidence, if not complacency, exuding a sense of luxury in everything she did. Days went by without any work done, spent solely relaxing in the state of being successful. Every night was full of champagne and parties, and every day was full of leisure and extravagant dishes.

Suddenly, one day, Caitlyn’s followers decreased a bit. Caitlyn, still drunk on the idea of being the best and most attractive, regarded it as an effect of her not uploading videos for a while. However, she started to feel that something was off after her followers began to decrease rapidly over a few weeks. That was when she realized all the changes. The comments, the views, and the followers were decreasing. The comments were asking her questions about the allegations made against her.

“Questions? What are they asking for? They believed in everything I told them,” Caitlyn thought to herself.

She quickly searched her name on SnapStarr, which was already a trending topic. Numerous videos popped up on the screen, ranging from creators on the Gold floor to The Star. They all had the same topic, written as a Starrtag in the title:

“★StopFalseAccusationsofCaitlyn.”

Caitlyn started to panic. Fear was evident in her eyes as she realized the privilege of living in the Star level was slipping away. She quickly watched one of the videos, which explained how Caitlyn had been falsely accusing influencers to earn fame.

After watching the video, Caitlyn began thinking of ways to evade this rumor, though she knew it was true. That was when she noticed Violet’s name in one of the trending titles.

“About Caitlyn.”

Two simple words were the title of the video. Caitlyn felt reluctant to click on it but ultimately did so, driven by the fear of losing her fame.

Violet, sitting at a desk without any other devices or papers, began to talk.

Violet detailed how Caitlyn had betrayed her by making false rumors, despite the fact that they had been friends since their days as nobodies. Violet presented concrete evidence that revealed the falsity of Caitlyn's deepfaked video, disproving all of Caitlyn's allegations.

Caitlyn felt sick. The guilt of betrayal was unsettling—not masked by the desire for fame as it had been before. Or perhaps it was simply the fear of losing everything.

Alarmed by Violet's video and the rapidly decreasing number of views and followers, Caitlyn quickly filmed a video of herself denying Violet's claims. However, it was too late. The comments on her new video exploded, all criticizing Caitlyn for what she had done.

The fans who once glorified and supported Caitlyn's every action, her loyal Cupcakes, were now gone. The fingers she had pointed at others were now pointing at herself. Shocked to the point of near trauma, Caitlyn shook her head in disbelief. She wasn't ready to fathom this whole situation. That was when an alarm sounded.

"You have been demoted."

A simple yet impactful message appeared on her phone. The SnapStarr app was deleted from her device, and Caitlyn didn't even have a chance to run as her room filled with the same gas she had seen during her plastic surgery. However, this time, Caitlyn never woke up.

Her hands remained on her phone, lifeless.